Weekly Paper Digest

Generated: 2026-04-15 15:38 Period: Last 15 days (2026-03-31 to 2026-04-15)
Total: 32 papers (27 with abstract, 30 with PDF)

Contents

Strategy

Strategic Management Journal

1. From armed roots to airline routes in South America: A dual imprinting perspective

Authors: Kunyuan Qiao, Shon R. Hiatt, Wesley D. Sine
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70084
Published: 2026-04-09

Keywords: emerging markets, history, imprinting, internationalization, stakeholders, strategy

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, International Business, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Imprinting Theory, Organizational Identity, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

Reserch Summary: We propose that founding partner relationships can leave distinct imprints on organizations that differ in durability and in how they respond to subsequent changes involving the founding partner. Examining South American airlines founded between 1919 and 1984, we argue and find that such relation- ships simultaneously create an internal capability imprint, enhancing operational performance and facili- tating international expansion, and an external identity imprint, constraining expansion by triggering national security concerns among foreign regulators. Internal capabilities persist longer because they are embedded in organizational structures and tacit knowledge, while external identity resides in more malleable stakeholder perceptions. Post-founding changes to the imprinter reshape these effects asymmetrically: the transition to civilian air traffic control erodes the competitive advan- tage of military-derived capabilities by diffusing previ- ously scarce expertise, while military coups intensify the negative consequences of a military-associated identity. These findings advance a dual imprinting perspective and contribute to strategy research by explaining persistent organizational heterogeneity through founding-era capabilities and identities. Received: 12 September 2025 Revised: 30 January 2026 Accepted: 23 February 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70084 Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–37. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. 1 Managerial Summary: When launching a venture, founders instinctively seek to collaborate with powerful partners such as celebrated investors and high-profile board members. Those relationships leave two distinct legacies. The first is operational: the knowledge and systems a powerful partner brings embed themselves deeply, sharpening capabilities that sustain competitive advantage for years. The second is reputational: the outside world immediately begins to categorize your organization through that association, and that categorization can be hard to escape. Our research on South American airlines shows how military-era founding partners produced operational excellence that fueled international growth, while simultaneously creating a security-sensitive identity that blocked market access in politically sensitive contexts. The lesson for founders: think several moves ahead. The question is not solely what this partner can give us today, but how will we be seen if his or her reputation shifts tomorrow. K E Y W O R D S emerging markets, history, imprinting, internationalization, stakeholders, strategy 1 |

`Qiao - From armed roots to airline routes in South America A dual imprinting perspectiv.`

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2. Beyond coal: When can outsider stakeholders drive transformative change?

Authors: Todd Schifeling, Thomas P. Lyon, Ion Bogdan Vasi
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70087
Published: 2026-04-08

Keywords: adaptation, climate change mitigation, electric utilities, external environment, new stakeholder theory, social movement theory, stakeholder enfranchisement

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Stakeholder Management
- **Theories:** Stakeholder Theory, Social Movement Theory, Resource Dependency Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Organizations grant stake- holders who provide valuable resources insider status in governance, excluding less valuable outsiders. Firms thereby assemble a value-maximizing resource portfo- lio but face challenges when environmental shifts require adaptation that harms some insiders. We com- bine and extend new stakeholder and social movement theories, hypothesizing how various stakeholders influence such adaptation. Outsiders can enable adaptation depending on organizational governance and the array of insider stakeholders. For-profit firms are less open to outsider influence, but a wider array of insiders enables outsiders to align with certain groups to overcome the opposition of others who resist change. The nature of these alignments shapes whether adaptation involves transformative divestments or exploratory investments. We test our theory in the context of the Beyond Coal movement to divest coal plants. Managerial Summary: To gain access to valuable resources, organizations commit to stakeholders who provide these resources. However, this creates prob- lems when adapting to changes in the environment that undermine the value of these resources. How can managers balance their stakeholder commitments with the need to integrate the concerns of other stakeholders demanding adaptive changes? We find that organiza- tional governance and the configuration of stakeholder interests can create openings for adaptation. Studying a period of rapid environmental change in the US electric Received: 19 December 2022 Revised: 8 January 2026 Accepted: 23 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70087 Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–34. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. 1 utility industry, for-profit utilities were more likely to retire coal generators when activists aligned with con- sumer advocates, and more likely to invest in solar gen- erators when activists aligned with prosumers. K E Y W O R D S adaptation, climate change mitigation, electric utilities, external environment, new stakeholder theory, social movement theory, stakeholder enfranchisement 1 |

`Schifeling - Beyond coal When can outsider stakeholders drive transformative change.pdf`

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3. Thinking and feeling about novelty: How cognition and emotion shape investment in novel ideas

Authors: Matthew P. Mount, Henry Tue Le, Gary Bowman, Christopher Golding
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70085
Published: 2026-04-04

Keywords: cognition, emotion, framing, innovation, novelty, technology

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Behavioral Strategy
- **Theories:** Construal Level Theory, Appraisal Theory of Emotion, Cognitive Framing

Abstract:

While prior research on the strategic framing of innova- tion highlights the cognitive mechanisms underlying novelty evaluation, we know little about the corresponding emotional mechanisms. Drawing on appraisal theory, construal level theory, and the litera- ture on emotions, we theorize two distinct appraisal- emotion pathways through which the framing of novel ideas evokes hope and awe among investors with differ- ent motives. We argue that high-construal framing sup- plements economically motivated investors' low-level feasibility orientation, which evokes hope and increases their willingness to invest. By contrast, low-construal framing supplements non-economically motivated investors' high-level desirability orientation, which evokes awe and increases their willingness to invest. We test and find some support for these within-motive pathways across three studies. Our study offers new The first author led the project; all subsequent authors contributed equally to the development of the manuscript. Received: 26 April 2025 Revised: 12 March 2026 Accepted: 14 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70085 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–27. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 theoretical and practical insights on the strategic fram- ing of novel ideas. K E Y W O R D S cognition, emotion, framing, innovation, novelty, technology 1 |

`Mount - Thinking and feeling about novelty How cognition and emotion shape investment in.pdf`

Administrative Science Quarterly

1. A Curation Approach to Identity Management: The Costs of Combining Identity Expression and Suppression

Authors: Rachel D. Arnett, Serenity S. Lee, Patricia Faison Hewlin
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261431827
Published: 2026-04-13

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Human Resource Management, Diversity and Inclusion
- **Theories:** Social Identity Theory, Identity Management Theory, Psychological Ambivalence

Abstract:

> Many organizations want to increase diversity among their workforce, but employees from marginalized groups consistently face uncertainty about how to navigate their identities at work, which can lead to high turnover among these employees. To highlight the unexpected ways in which such risks can arise for employees and organizations, we investigate the intrapersonal conse- quences of a curation approach to navigating social identities in the workplace. Curation involves frequent identity expression (integrating an identity into the workplace, such as discussing identity-based traditions) and frequent identity suppression (concealing aspects of an identity at work, such as hiding concerns about discrimination). Given that expression and suppression both have bene- fits and risks, combining these behaviors into a curation approach could be seen as a socially adept and professionally beneficial solution. However, focus- ing on the intrapersonal experiences of employees of color, we argue that, compared to primarily expressing or primarily suppressing a minority identity, curation is more psychologically detrimental to these employees. Combining expression and suppression fosters ambivalence—conflicting thoughts about whether one' s identity is a resource or a liability—which is psychologically aver- sive. In two surveys and an internal meta-analysis (of the two studies in the manuscript and a supplemental study reported in supplementary online materi- als), curation was associated with greater ambivalence and psychological strain, which, in turn, were associated with greater turnover intentions. While our core findings emerge with employees of color, we also provide exploratory evidence that the costs of curation extend to women. Our findings regarding curation reveal a previously unrecognized well-being risk for employees from 1 University of Pennsylvania 2 Columbia University Corresponding author: Rachel D. Arnett, The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, Steinberg Hall –Dietrich Hall, Philadelphia, PA 19104 Email: rarnett@wharton.upenn.edu marginalized groups and a retention risk for organizations. We offer recommen- dations for future research and practice to address the conditions that lead employees to engage in curation.

`Arnett - A Curation Approach to Identity Management The Costs of Combining Identity Expre.pdf`

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2. Georg Rilinger. Failure by Design: The California Energy Crisis and the Limits of Market Planning

Authors: Adam Nix
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261439112
Published: 2026-04-02

Abstract not available. `Nix - Georg Rilinger. Failure by Design The California Energy Crisis and the Limits of.pdf`

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3. J. Doyne Farmer. Making Sense of Chaos: A Better Economics for a Better World

Authors: Subramanian Rangan
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261441578
Published: 2026-04-05

Abstract not available. `Rangan - J. Doyne Farmer. Making Sense of Chaos A Better Economics for a Better World.pdf`

Academy of Management Journal

1. Listen to Your Users? Self-Selection in User Community Feedback and Commercial Impact

Authors: Ryan T. Allen, Robert Bremner, Rory M. McDonald
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0178
Published: 2026-04-09

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Entrepreneurship, Product Development
- **Theories:** Self-Selection Theory, User Innovation, Demand Heterogeneity

Abstract:

Firms increasingly involve user communities in product development, and prior research documents many benefits in idea generation, knowledge sharing, and cost reduction. We theorize, however, that incorporating market feedback about products from these communities can harm products' commercial performance. Because community feedback is volunteered by self-selected participants rather than sampled to represent the broader market, it may mislead firms when narrow community preferences diverge from mainstream demand. We predict that greater incorporation of community feedback will increase positive evaluations of a product within the community, but undermine its broader commercial success when there are strong user self-selection pressures (like for initially niche-targeted games). We test this theory in the personal-computer (PC) video-game industry using Steam Early Access, where developers integrate community feedback prior to release. Using a multimethod design that combines large-scale archival analyses with interviews of developers, executives, and community members, we find that feedback incorporation during Early Access improves post-launch commercial outcomes of games only when the Early Access community closely mirrors the distribution of users in the broader Steam market. However, in unrepresentative communities—even large ones—greater incorporation predicts lower post-launch revenues despite favorable community evaluations.

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2. A Prosocial Perspective on Advice Seeking and Networking: How Focusing on What Advice Givers Can Gain Motivates Advice Seekers to Reach Out More

Authors: Anne Burmeister, Daniel Z. Levin
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0635
Published: 2026-04-09

Abstract not available.

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3. Time the Surge: Theorizing and Examining Team Pacing in Multiple-Membership Contexts

Authors: Chen Zhang, Ning Li, Xilan Zhang, Yi-An Deng, Laijie Yang
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0522
Published: 2026-04-08

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Team Dynamics, Project Management, Temporal Analysis
- **Theories:** Pacing Theory, Multiple Team Membership, Temporal Procedural Efficiency

Abstract:

Pacing has long been critical for understanding team work patterns. As organizations increasingly embrace multiple memberships, with workers engaged in different concurrent projects, it becomes important to understand how team pacing is uniquely shaped in such contexts. Extending beyond prior theories with single-membership assumptions, we theorize a new perspective on how team pacing is influenced by multiple memberships—contexts typically characterized by non-coinciding project portfolios across members. Based on this theorizing, we examined a large-scale dataset comprising over 1.6 million entries of project activities

involving 1,712 individuals across 415 team projects, and found that higher average multiple memberships among core members delayed the timing of a project's activity surge. This surge-delaying effect was mitigated, however, when project members shared greater external project overlap. An additional experiment revealed that the reduced perceived feasibility of holistic optimization was an important psychological mechanism underlying the surge-delaying effect. Furthermore, we found that projects with longer time spans were less likely to experience a surge, but for those that did, surge timing had implications for efficiency: projects with either a markedly early surge (i.e., initial phase) or a markedly late surge (i.e., final phase) exhibited greater temporal procedural efficiency than those with an intermediate-phase surge.

`Zhang - Time the Surge Theorizing and Examining Team Pacing in Multiple-Membership Conte.pdf`

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4. Algorithmic Facial Expression Analysis: A Novel Methodology to Advance Management Research on Emotions

Authors: Silvia Stroe, Charlotta Sirén, Vivianna Fang He, Barbara Burkhard, Vangelis Souitaris
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0826
Published: 2026-04-08

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Management Research Methods, Organizational Behavior, Artificial Intelligence, Emotions in Organizations
- **Theories:** Algorithmic Facial Expression Analysis (AFEA), Emotional Authenticity, Temporal Dynamics of Emotions

Abstract:

With the rapid advancement of artificial intelligence technologies, algorithmic facial expression analysis (AFEA) has emerged as a promising methodology to measure emotions. Despite rapid adoption across management subfields, however, the full scope of AFEA's theoretical potential remains underexplored. This paper provides a framework that links the AFEA measurement innovation to major opportunities for theoretical advancement around emotions in organizations. We start by describing the methodological basis of AFEA and reviewing its applications in management research to date. We then outline two core capabilities of AFEA—namely, capturing the temporal structure of emotions and detecting inauthentic expressions of emotions—and illustrate how these capabilities can enable theory advancement in management research. After presenting an empirical demonstration of AFEA's capabilities and a practical step-by-step guide for using it, we conclude by discussing key considerations for realizing the future potential of AFEA research.

`Stroe - Algorithmic Facial Expression Analysis A Novel Methodology to Advance Management`

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5. The Resource Insecurity Mindset: Why CEOs from Lower-Class Origins Are Both Greedier and More Generous

Authors: Timothy D. Hubbard, Lívia Markóczy, Aten Zaandam
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0347
Published: 2026-04-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Behavior, Upper Echelons, Social Class
- **Theories:** Upper Echelons Theory, Resource Insecurity Mindset, Evolutionary Theory, Social Psychology

Abstract:

Understanding how executives' backgrounds influence corporate behavior is essential for organizational science and society. Previous research offers conflicting predictions about whether childhood resource scarcity leads to self-focused or prosocial tendencies, with evolutionary theories predicting greed and social psy-

chology theories pointing to generosity. This contradiction is especially relevant for chief executive officers (CEOs), whose decisions significantly impact stakeholders. Here, we show that CEOs from lower social class origins engage in both more greedy behaviors (e.g., pursuing excessive compensation) and more prosocial behaviors (e.g., internal corporate social responsibility) than their higher-class counterparts. Using survey data from 135 S&P 1500 CEOs, we demonstrate that both behaviors stem from the same psychological mechanism: a resource insecurity mindset formed during childhood. This mindset makes lower-class origin CEOs simultaneously vigilant about personal resource accumulation and compassionate toward others facing constraints. We examine how CEO job insecurity and overconfidence influence these effects. Through experiments, coded CEO interviews, and executive qualitative interviews, we find broad support for our theory. These findings resolve a significant theoretical contradiction by showing that self-serving and other-serving behaviors can coexist and share common roots. Understanding these dual behavioral tendencies has important implications for corporate governance, executive selection, and organizational inequality.

`Hubbard - The Resource Insecurity Mindset Why CEOs from Lower-Class Origins Are Both Greed.pdf`

Academy of Management Review

1. Competitive Dynamics are Alive with the Sound of Music: A Reply to "Time to Face the Music"

Authors: Eric Y. Lee, John R. Busenbark, Michael C. Withers, Edward J. Zajac
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2025.1029
Published: 2026-04-10

Abstract not available. `Lee - Competitive Dynamics are Alive with the Sound of Music A Reply to "Time to Face.pdf`

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2. Leaders on the Other Side of Voice: Extending Black et al.'s Integrative Theory of Collective Voice

Authors: Xiaoran Hu, Chang Su
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2025.0769
Published: 2026-04-09

Abstract not available. `Hu - Leaders on the Other Side of Voice Extending Black et al.'s Integrative Theory o.pdf`

Organization Science

1. Where Sentence Is Served: Entrepreneurship and Socioeconomic Mobility Among Ex-Offenders

Authors: Vera Rocha, Stefanie Sayuri Sunao
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19965
Published: 2026-04-09

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Labor Markets, Social Inequality, Socioeconomic Mobility
- **Theories:** Push vs. Pull Entrepreneurship, Human Capital Theory, Labor Market Barriers, Socioeconomic Mobility Framework

Abstract:

Entrepreneurship is often promoted as a pathway to upward mobility, especially for those who face barriers in traditional labor markets. However, whether and when entrepreneurship truly improves the long-term prospects of individuals with criminal records remains poorly understood. This study examines how the type of sentences—community service versus short incarceration—shapes ex-offenders' employment routes and socioeconomic outcomes. Using three decades of Danish registry data, we compare individuals convicted of similar offenses but given different sentences and follow their trajectories over time. We find that incarceration substantially increases the likelihood that ex-offenders enter entrepreneurship as an alternative to wage work. However, this career path proves costly: compared with those who secure regular employment, individuals who pursue entrepreneurship after release earn persistently lower income and are more likely to reoffend. Mechanism analyses show that transitions into entrepreneurship concentrate among groups facing the steepest hiring barriers—foreign-born individuals, those without vocational training, residents of high-unemployment areas, and offenders convicted of property crimes or serving longer sentences—suggesting that entrepreneurship often reflects "push" rather than "pull" dynamics. Relative to unemployment, entrepreneurship is associated with modestly lower recidivism but similar income penalties. Our findings add nuance to the narrative of entrepreneurship as an emancipatory route for marginalized populations. They highlight the risks of relying on entrepreneurship as a re-integration strategy and underscore the need for organizational and policy interventions that expand access to stable jobs and provide targeted support for people with criminal records. Funding: Financial support from the Carlsberg Foundation (Carlsbergfondet) [Grant CF21-0156] is gratefully acknowledged. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19965 .

📄 Rocha - Where Sentence Is Served Entrepreneurship and Socioeconomic Mobility Among Ex-Of.pdf

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2. Newborn Gender and Technology Adoption Among Rural Entrepreneurs in Ethiopian Family Firms

Authors: Salvatore Di Falco, Luisa Gagliardi, Valerio Pelucco
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19985
Published: 2026-04-07

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Family Business, Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management, Development Economics
- **Theories:** Family-Firm Paradigm, Succession Norms, Rational Expectations, Gender Socialization

Abstract:

This paper investigates how the gender composition of potential heirs influences technology adoption decisions in family-owned agricultural microenterprises. Drawing on primary field data from three waves of panel surveys of 734 rural households in Ethiopia (2013–2019), we exploit the exogenous microshock of a newborn child's gender to isolate its causal impact on farmers' uptake of new technologies. We find that the arrival of a son—rather than a daughter—significantly increases the likelihood of adopting agricultural innova tions. Additional analyses suggest that this heterogeneity is driven primarily by a combina tion of gendered social and succession norms that prioritize men over women in agricultural leadership together with parents' rational expectations about sons' future involvement in the family business. Our findings contribute to research on entrepreneurship and development by identifying family structure—specifically, heirs' gender—as a novel determinant of tech nology adoption. More broadly, by situating the analysis within the family-firm paradigm, we argue that these dynamics extend beyond low-income settings; in many developing and advanced economies, gender biases in succession norms may systematically shape strategic investment decisions and long-term business sustainability. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19985.

📄 Falco - Newborn Gender and Technology Adoption Among Rural Entrepreneurs in Ethiopian Fa.pdf

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3. Playing to the Audiences: How Creative Producers Manage and Reconcile Different and Copresent Valuation Standards

Authors: Patrick Reilly
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.18684
Published: 2026-04-06

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Creative Industries, Sociology of Valuation, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Practical Annealing, Valuation Theory, Practice Theory, Micro-interactional Sociology

Abstract:

This study examines how individual creative producers navigate conflicting valu ation standards when multiple audience types are copresent. Drawing on a multiyear participant-observation study of stand-up comedy in Los Angeles, I introduce practical annealing as a real-time, cue-driven competency through which performers reconcile hetero geneous standards across casual consumers, peers, and gatekeepers. Practical annealing unfolds through three situated practices: audience profiling (inferring likely sensibilities from contextual and interactional cues), audience orchestration (forging a workable collective from disparate evaluators), and audience triangulation (surfacing overlaps and selectively prioritizing standards to guide performance choices). I show that the latitude to anneal is not uniform. Permission structures rooted in demographic prototyping and status expand or restrict what moves are legible and sanctionable. Although enacted within moments on stage, repeated reconciliations aggregate into career orientations—toward broad malleability or niche grounding—with implications for bookings, visibility, and market position. Concep tually, the paper shifts attention from evaluators to the subjects of evaluation, specifying real-time practices for managing evaluative plurality under copresence and distinguishing it from sequential experimentation or improvisation. The framework clarifies when and for whom real-time reconciliation is feasible and how microinteractional skill scales into durable trajectories in cultural production and other audience-dependent work.

`Reilly - Playing to the Audiences How Creative Producers Manage and Reconcile Different`
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4. Other People's Children: How Diversity Without Inclusion Impacts Community Support for Public Schools

Authors: Farzam Boroomand, Aseem Kaul
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19351
Published: 2026-04-03

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Public Management, Diversity and Inclusion, Sociology
- **Theories:** Social Capital Theory, Stakeholder Theory, Social Identity Theory, Intergroup Contact Theory

Abstract:

Organizations pursuing activities that advance the public interest often require support from their local communities, but such support may be harder to come by in more racially diverse communities. In this study, we argue that this negative effect of racial diversity on support for organizations serving the public interest will be weaker the more inclusive the community, especially where community inclusion is accompanied by shared values among members of different groups and where the organizations themselves are racially representative. We test and find support for these predictions by looking at one specific type of public service organization: public schools in the United States. Specifically, we find that community support for public schools—both generally in terms of local spending per pupil and specifically as the bond amounts residents vote to approve—is negatively associated with racial diversity within a school district, but this negative relation only holds for less inclusive communities where members of different groups are less likely to live close to each other or to have social ties with each other. We further find that this moderating effect of community inclusion is complemented by shared values and organi zational representativeness, so that diversity has the most negative effect in less inclusive communities where members of different races differ in their political beliefs and

schools are relatively segregated, and no significant effect in inclusive communities with shared values and integrated schools. Our study sheds new light on the conditions under which organizations seeking to address grand challenges can benefit from strong community support. Open Access Statement: This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial 4.0 International License. You are free to download this work and share with others for any pur pose, except commercially, and you must attribute this work as "Organization Science. Copyright © 2026 The Author(s). https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19351, used under a Creative Commons Attribution License: https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc/4.0/." Funding: This work was supported by the Carlson School of Management [DEI Research Grant] and the Responsible Research in Business and Management [Dare to Care Scholorship]. Supplemental Material: The online appendices are available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19351.

 Boroomand - Other People's Children How Diversity Without Inclusion Impacts Community Suppor.pdf

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5. Through the Lens of Clarity: Perceived Organizational Tightness Boosts Creativity for Men, but Not for Women

Authors: Grace J. H. Lim, Roy Y. J. Chua
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2023.17571
Published: 2026-04-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Organizational Culture, Innovation Management, Gender Studies
- **Theories:** Social Information Processing Theory, Social Role Theory, Cultural Tightness-Looseness Theory, Social Cognitive Theory

Abstract:

A commonly held perspective in the cultural tightness literature is that cultural tightness tends to negatively impact creativity. Yet some findings indicate that this relationship is not strictly negative and that a more nuanced perspective should be considered. Drawing on social information processing (SIP) theory and social role theory, we build theory on how the perception of organizational cultural tightness can increase creativity for some employees, but not for others. Specifically, we propose that perceived organizational tightness—the extent to which one perceives that an organization is characterized by strong norms and sanctions for deviation—increases clarity on creativity evaluation standards and that gender moderates this relationship such that the effect is stronger for men than for women. Clarity on creativity evaluation standards subsequently enhances creative self-efficacy, which, in turn, boosts employee creativity. Across four studies (a two-wave online study, a two-wave multisource field study, and two online experiments), we found evidence supporting our theory. This research extends our understanding of when, how, and why the perceived tightness of an organization' s culture influences employee creativity. Theoretical and practical implications are discussed. Funding: This research was supported by the Nanyang Technological University Start-Up Grant awarded to G. J. H. Lim and the Singapore Ministry of Education (MOE) Academic Research Fund (AcRF) Tier 2 [Grant T2EP40120-0001] awarded to R. Y. J. Chua. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.17571 .

 Lim - Through the Lens of Clarity Perceived Organizational Tightness Boosts Creativity.p

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Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Replication Studies in Entrepreneurship: Mapping Current Efforts and Identifying Future Opportunities

Authors: Carolin Krieweth, Sebastian Kruse, Jeremy C. Short, Liljan Ruth Maren Schrameier, Malte Brettel

DOI: 10.1177/10422587261415935
Published: 2026-04-02

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Research Methods, Meta-Research
- **Theories:** Scientific Progress, Replication Logic, Research Transparency

Abstract:

Although scholars recognize the importance of replication for advancing scientific progress, lit- tle is known about the extent to which replication efforts have informed entrepreneurship research. This research brief systematically reviews the body of replication studies in the field, examining which replication designs have been employed and where future efforts could be directed. We find that conceptual extension and empirical generalization replication designs dominate, while checking of analysis and exact replications remain rare. We advocate for greater use of diverse replication designs, highlight promising avenues for future replication efforts, and propose specific practices to strengthen transparency, documentation, and reproducibility.

`Krieweth - Replication Studies in Entrepreneurship Mapping Current Efforts and Identifyi`

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2. A Blessing in Disguise: Logic (In)Compatibility, Centrality, and Social Innovation in Hybrid Social Ventures

Authors: Jiawei Sophia Fu
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261435951
Published: 2026-04-06

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Social Entrepreneurship, Organizational Theory, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Institutional Logics Perspective, Hybrid Organizing, Entrepreneurial Orientation

Abstract:

Multiple institutional logics can create problematic tensions—and synergies catalyzing innova- tion. This study examines when and how organizational hybridity—the interaction between logic incompatibility and centrality—fosters innovation. Survey and expert evaluation data from 318 social ventures (SVs) supported a mediated moderation model. Perceived centrality of social–market logics exerts opposite moderating effects: Centrality amplifies the inverted U-shaped relationship between logic incompatibility and social innovation, an effect that entrepreneurial orientation (EO) partially mediates. However, centrality weakens the inverted U-shaped rela- tionship between incompatibility and EO. These findings provide nuanced, novel insights into hybrid organizing and social innovation, highlighting the unique trade-offs SVs face.

`Fu - A Blessing in Disguise Logic (In)Compatibility, Centrality, and Social Innovatio.pd`

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3. Would Family Firms Approaching Succession Prioritize Innovation Investment or Empire Building? A Temporal SEW Perspective

Authors: Zhongjuan Sun, Jialin Feng, Jijun Gao
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261435911
Published: 2026-04-06

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Family Business
- **Theories:** Socioemotional Wealth (SEW) Perspective, Temporal Construal Theory

Abstract:

This study develops a temporal socioemotional wealth (SEW) perspective to examine how fam- ily firms' strategic decisions shift as intergenerational succession approaches. Integrating SEW perspective with temporal construal theory, we argue that perceived proximity to succession triggers a shift from aspiration-based to temporal-needs-based SEW, reducing the salience of long-term benefits such as innovation while increasing the appeal of short-term concrete actions such as asset investment. Using data on pre-succession Chinese family firms, we find that firms approaching succession reduce R&D investment while increasing asset investment over time. Successor preparation weakens, while sibling competition strengthens, these effects. Our find- ings highlight the importance of temporal distance to succession in shaping SEW priorities and offer new insights into heterogeneity among family firms.

`Sun - Would Family Firms Approaching Succession Prioritize Innovation Investment or Em.pdf`

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4. Investing in Data Quality for High-Impact Entrepreneurship Research

Authors: Markku Maula, Tomasz Mickiewicz, Silvio Vismara, Johan Wiklund
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261435916
Published: 2026-04-06

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Research Methodology
- **Theories:** 5I Framework (Data Quality), Research Design Trade-offs

Abstract:

High-impact entrepreneurship research stands or falls with data quality. Yet research design and data collection choices often force researchers into trade-offs among relevance, validity, and replicability. Reliance on existing databases constrains the questions we can study, while primary data collection to address new questions often struggles to deliver high-quality, large, and repre- sentative samples. Increasingly, the most tangible contributions come from unique, high-quality data that answer novel, important questions. We present a 5I framework (Invest, Integrate, Innovate, Incentivize, Impact), offering guidance for authors, reviewers, and editors to navigate these trade-offs and build unique datasets that enable relevant, valid, and replicable research.

`Maula - Investing in Data Quality for High-Impact Entrepreneurship Research.pdf`

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. It's a match! Similarity in personality traits in the business angel–founder dyad and follow-on funding

Authors: Angela Altmeier, Christian Fisch
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70025
Published: 2026-04-10

Keywords: business angels, follow-on funding, machine learning, personality traits, similarity

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Finance, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Person-Environment Fit (Supplementary and Complementary), Big Five Personality Traits, Dyadic Interaction

Abstract:

Research summary: We assess how personality alignment in investor–founder dyads is associated with the likelihood of follow-on funding, a vital outcome for early-stage ven- tures. Using machine learning to infer the Big Five personal- ity traits from Twitter data for 9497 business angel–founder dyads, we find that similarity in conscientiousness and agreeableness is associated with a higher likelihood of follow-on funding, while similarity in neuroticism is associ- ated with a lower likelihood. We attribute these patterns to the trait-specific benefits of supplementary (conscientious- ness and agreeableness) and complementary (neuroticism) fit. Robustness checks and additional analyses support and nuance the conclusion that personality fit matters for ven- ture outcomes, highlighting the strategic role of personality fit in the investor–founder relationship. Managerial summary: We show that personality similarity between business angels and founders is associated with whether a venture secures follow-on funding. Similarity in conscientiousness (being organized and reliable) and agree- ableness (being cooperative and trusting) is linked to a higher likelihood of securing follow-on funding, while simi- larity in neuroticism (emotional instability) is linked to a lower likelihood. We interpret these patterns as collabora- tion dynamics: similarity can help through supplementary fit (e.g., shared work style and cooperation), but differences Received: 10 July 2025 Revised: 8 January 2026 Accepted: 17 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70025 © 2026 Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–40. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 can help through complementary fit (e.g., one partner's emotional stability offsets the other's emotional instability). Practically, founders and business angels should develop self-awareness and consider personality fit alongside other characteristics when forming partnerships. Policymakers and incubators can support better matches and strengthen collaboration by promoting awareness of interpersonal dynamics. K E Y W O R D S business angels, follow-on funding, machine learning, personality traits, similarity 1 |

`□Altmeier - It's a match! Similarity in personality traits in the business angel–founder dya.pdf`

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2. Two hearts that beat as one: Signals, narratives, and financing (less) novel ventures via equity crowdfunding

Authors: Jiahe Wang, Lien Denoo, Joris Knoben
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70026
Published: 2026-04-07

Keywords: entrepreneurial finance, entrepreneurial narratives, novelty, qualitative comparative analysis, signaling theory

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Finance, Crowdfunding
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Entrepreneurial Narratives, Configurational Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Financial resource acquisition is crucial for ventures but hindered by uncertainty. While signaling mitigates this uncertainty, its effectiveness hinges on ven- ture novelty and the narratives used to clarify embedded information. Adopting a configurational lens, we examine the interplay among novelty, signals, and narratives in equity crowdfunding (ECF). Applying qualitative compara- tive analysis (QCA) to 98 ventures on a UK ECF platform, we reveal multiple equifinal pathways to fundraising suc- cess and demonstrate that novelty acts as a critical contin- gency factor: novel and less-novel ventures require distinct configurations of signals and narratives, and narratives that clarify signals play a crucial role for novel ventures. Our findings extend research on signaling theory, entrepreneur- ial narratives, and entrepreneurial finance with a nuanced understanding of the interdependence among novelty, sig- nals, and narratives. Managerial Summary: Novel and less-novel ventures face distinct challenges in convincing investors, and we show that there is no "one-size-fits-all" strategy in fundraising. Our study demonstrates how entrepreneurs can convince investors using signals and/or narratives that align with the novelty of their ventures. For novel ventures, specific and coherent narratives are particularly helpful in clarifying Received: 28 January 2025 Revised: 26 March 2026 Accepted: 30 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70026 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–27. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 signals that contain complex information. Conversely, less-novel ventures that refine existing offerings may improve fundraising performance by simply emphasizing signals that demonstrate clear product-market fit. We therefore suggest that entrepreneurs should view signals and narratives as complementary tools and tailor their fundraising strategies to match their ventures' novelty and achieve fundraising success. K E Y W O R D S entrepreneurial finance, entrepreneurial narratives, novelty, qualitative comparative analysis, signaling theory 1 |

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3. Visionary, engineer, and experimenter: Three forms of entrepreneurship in the quest for product–market fit

Authors: Thomas Zellweger, Djordje Djokovic
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70024
Published: 2026-04-05

Keywords: active inference, entrepreneurship, product–market fit, theory-based view, uncertainty

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Product–Market Fit
- **Theories:** Theory-Based View, Uncertainty Theory, Behavioral Theory of the Firm

Abstract:

Research summary: Entrepreneurship unfolds under uncer- tainty, which complicates entrepreneurs' efforts to align idea, action, and environment to reach product–market fit. To illuminate how entrepreneurs perform such alignment, we complement the theory-based view and its focus on cognitive uncertainty with a discussion of behavioral uncer- tainty. We propose that entrepreneurs face four types of uncertainty: (1) uncertainty about the state of their environ- ment (state uncertainty), (2) uncertainty about the interpretation of environmental cues (perception uncertainty), (3) uncertainty about the feasibility of turning an idea into a tangible product (execution uncertainty), and (4) uncertainty about the effect of their action in the environment (effect uncertainty). To mitigate these forms of uncertainty, entre- preneurs engage in idea–environment (entrepreneurs as visionaries), idea–action (entrepreneurs as engineers), and action–environment (entrepreneurs as experimenters) align- ment. Each of these alignment strategies is associated with benefits and constraints in mitigating the uncertainty dis- cussed. Our paper thus generates new insights into the nature of uncertainty and its effective mitigation in the quest for product–market fit, a critical precursor of success in entrepreneurship. Received: 7 October 2025 Revised: 24 March 2026 Accepted: 26 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70024 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–23. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 Managerial summary: Entrepreneurship succeeds when product and market are aligned. We map two sources of uncertainty that stand in the way of reaching product–market fit. Agentic uncertainty concerns the entrepreneur: interpreting signals (perception uncertainty) and making the idea work (execution uncertainty). Environmental uncer- tainty concerns the market: what state the market is in (state uncertainty) and how the market will react to prod- ucts (effect uncertainty). Entrepreneurs can mitigate these uncertainties via three complementary strategies: (1) idea–environment alignment ("visionary" scanning the environ- ment), (2) idea–action alignment ("engineering" to prove feasibility), and (3) action–environment alignment ("experi- menter" testing to learn what sells). Each alignment strategy yields benefits and costs toward reaching product–market fit. In combination, they accelerate product–market fit—a critical driver of success in entrepreneurship. K E Y W O R D S active inference, entrepreneurship, product–market fit, theory- based view, uncertainty 1 |

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4. Academic entrepreneurs' material engagements in the creation of science-based ventures

Authors: Elimar Pires Vasconcellos, Jonathan Wareham, Laia Pujol Priego
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70023
Published: 2026-04-03

Keywords: academic entrepreneurship (AE), material engagements, opportunity, science-based ventures (SBVs)

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Science-Based Ventures, Innovation Management, Practice Theory
- **Theories:** Opportunity Creation Theory, Practice Theory, Pragmatism, Evolutionary Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: This paper examines the creation of entrepreneurial opportunities under coupled technical and demand uncertainty within science-based ventures (SBVs). Whereas opportunity creation theory emphasizes discursive processes, we build on practice theory and pragmatism to explore how SBV opportunities also emerge through entre- preneurs' evolving engagements with indeterminate mate- rial artifacts. Through a longitudinal multiple-case study, we identify two patterns of material engagement: epistemic engagement, oriented toward knowledge creation, and pragmatic engagement, oriented toward practical use. We show how opportunity creation unfolds through interweav- ing cycles of epistemic and pragmatic engagement. By intro- ducing material engagements as constitutive, we specify creation theory for SBVs and highlight the central role of materiality in shaping belief formation, opportunity objecti- fication, stakeholder engagement, and the variation–selec- tion–retention process. Managerial Summary: This paper explores how entrepre- neurs create science-based ventures (SBVs) by engaging with evolving material artifacts, like sensors and prototypes. Based on a study of SBV initiatives supported by the European Commission's ATTRACT program, we identify a process in which entrepreneurs repeatedly alternate † Deceased. Received: 9 March 2026 Revised: 9 March 2026 Accepted: 19 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70023 © 2026 Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–33. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 between epistemic engagement—focused on scientific understanding—and pragmatic engagement—focused on usability and implementation. This material engagement cycle plays a central role in venture development under coupled technical and demand uncertainty. We highlight tensions inherent in this process and the strategies through which they are accommodated, offering practical insights for entrepreneurs building ventures from frontier science and policymakers supporting science commercialization. K E Y W O R D S academic entrepreneurship (AE), material engagements, opportunity, science-based ventures (SBVs) 1 |

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5. The impact of workers' compensation laws on entrepreneurial activity

Authors: Indu Khurana, Daniel J. Lee, Julio O. de Castro
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70017
Published: 2026-04-01

Keywords: entrepreneurial activity, new business registration, time, two-way fixed effects, workers' compensation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Public Policy, Labor Economics, Entrepreneurial Entry
- **Theories:** Liquidity Constraints, Time Allocation Theory, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Government policy that aims to stimu- late business activity often overlooks its indirect impacts on entrepreneurial entry. In particular, the role of free time, especially in concert with liquidity constraints, remains an underexplored factor. In this paper, we exploit two exoge- nous shocks to workers' free time to furnish plausibly causal effects on entrepreneurial activity: (random) injury and the 2011 amendments to the Illinois workers' compensation laws. Utilizing a two-way fixed effects estimation, we find that as workers' compensation becomes less generous, that is, by limiting both financial resources and an employee's time away from work, entrepreneurial activity within a spe- cific geographical region is significantly reduced. Thus, we provide evidence of an unintended and negative impact on entrepreneurial activity caused by an indirect policy change. Further, this result unduly affects the recently injured or otherwise disabled. Our results are robust to alternative specifications and data sources, suggesting an important incidence of compensatory insurance regulation on entre- preneurial activity and, as a result, important considerations for future policymaking. Managerial Summary: Workers' compensation is a state- level program that provides replacement wages to workers injured on the job. In 2011, amendments to Illinois' workers' Received: 9 December 2022 Revised: 16 January 2026 Accepted: 13 February 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70017 © 2026 Strategic

Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–26. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 compensation laws made this program less generous in terms of both financial benefits and time out of work. We study the impact of these amendments on entrepreneurial activity. We find that less generous workers' compensation has a large adverse effect on entrepreneurial activity because it constrains two important factors required for experimentation with entrepreneurship: financial resources and time. Our results hold up to several statistical models and controls, including local innovative and high-tech firms, as well as alternative datasets. Our findings yield important insights for policymakers in other states drafting such regu- lations and for researchers studying the incidence of such policies. K E Y W O R D S entrepreneurial activity, new business registration, time, two-way fixed effects, workers' compensation 1 |

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General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Bridging Knowledge Capability Gaps: Digital Technology Offsetting in Interfirm Knowledge Transfer

Authors: Antony Paulraj, Chandrasekararao Seepana, Murtaza Faruquee, Vaidyanathan Jayaraman
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70101
Published: 2026-04-10

Keywords: absorptive capacity, digital era, digital technology, disseminative capacity, knowledge transfer, relational performance

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Interfirm Knowledge Transfer, Digital Transformation
- **Theories:** Relational View, Signaling Theory, Absorptive Capacity, Disseminative Capacity

Abstract:

Abstract In this digital age, the adoption of digital technology (DT) is changing traditional business processes. Against this backdrop, we try to answer the question of whether DT could effectively bridge any interfirm knowledge capability gaps. Though effective knowledge transfer is dependent on the sender's and the receiver's knowledge capabilities, literature attributes very limited attention to their combined effects. Using signalling metaphor as the guiding framework, we forward disseminative capacity and absorptive capacity as the key capabilities of the sender and receiver, respectively, and study their combined effects on relational performance within vertical interfirm relationships. Additionally, with the belief that comprehending how DT could interplay with these capabilities holds crucial importance, we test the conjecture that DT can bridge knowledge capability gaps pertaining to the sender or the receiver. We position our hypotheses using the relational view and test them using the response surface methodology. The analysis is conducted based on a multi-respondent dyadic survey dataset that is augmented with secondary data and longitudinal performance data. Our findings showcase that disseminative capacity and absorptive capacity are natural counterparts and that the channel effectiveness resulting from adopting DT could serve as an offsetting capability that can effectively bridge certain knowledge capability gaps.

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2. The Effect of Board Leadership Roles and Committee Responsibilities on Governance Effectiveness

Authors: Shelby L. Gai, J. Yo-Jud Cheng
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70100
Published: 2026-04-06

Keywords: attention-based view, board design, board of directors, corporate governance, governance effectiveness

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Board Design
- **Theories:** Attention-Based View, Cognitive Foundations, Cognitive Load Theory

Abstract:

Abstract Expectations for corporate directors have expanded over time, placing growing demands on their time and attention. Drawing on the cognitive foundations of the attention-based view (ABV), we theorize that board directors' leadership roles and committee assignments shape their attentional perspective and engagement in ways that can both hinder and enhance governance effectiveness. Using a panel dataset of 39,610 board-committee-year observations from over 3000 US boards between 1999 and 2023, we examine how directors' roles and responsibilities relate to governance outcomes associated with boards' audit, compensation, and nomination committees. We find that holding more board-leadership roles and board-committee assignments may impose cognitive burdens that undermine governance effectiveness, whereas holding more-diversified committee assignments may enhance governance by enabling directors to sequence their attention more strategically across governance tasks. This examination thus advances our theoretical understanding of how attention functions when distributed across multiple organizations simultaneously. In addition, by moving beyond simple counts of board directorships to explicitly consider the number and configuration of directors' leadership roles and committee responsibilities, this study advances the literature on governance effectiveness and board design. In doing so, we highlight the value of committee-level analysis for understanding board dynamics and governance.

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Journal of Management

1. Where Do Transitioning Executives Go? Exploring Demand-Side and Supply-Side Drivers of Destination Rivalry

Authors: Joseph S. Harrison, Ryan Krause, René M. Bakker, Zhiyan Wu
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261428060
Published: 2026-04-14

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Human Capital, Competitive Strategy, Labor Markets
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Human Capital Theory, Destination Rivalry

Abstract:

Executive movement to close rivals can have significant implications for firm competitiveness. While prior research has provided valuable insights into the antecedents of executive search and turnover in general, the theoretical understanding of where executives go when they move remains underdeveloped. We extend research in this area by introducing the concept of destination rivalry, defined as the degree of market commonality and resource similarity between an executive's departure firm and destination firm. We then develop a theoretical model of key demand-side and supply-side factors associated with an executive's position in the departure firm that explains movement to a closer versus more distant rivals. We theorize that among executives moving between firms, destination rivalry will be higher when the executive possesses competition-specific human capital (e.g., via core functional experience or corporate or divisional experience at the departure firm), has a larger pay gap to the CEO, and especially when both factors are present. Empirical tests of the theoretical model using a sample of executive movements from S&P 1500 firms to other public companies between 1993 and 2023 are largely consistent with these predictions. Our findings contribute to research on executive Acknowledgments: The authors would like to acknowledge instrumental feedback and editorial guidance from Hermann Ndofor and two anonymous reviewers during the development of this research. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Joseph S. Harrison, Haslam College of Business, University of Tennessee, 453 Haslam Business Building, Knoxville, TN 37996, USA.

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2. Is My Boss Gaslighting Me? Uncovering the Nomological Network of Gaslighting In Leader-Employee Relationships

Authors: Babatunde (Tunde) Ogunfowora, Joshua S. BourdageUniversity of Calgary
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261426014
Published: 2026-04-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Leadership, Workplace Mistreatment, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Power-Dependence Theory, Destructive Leadership, Nomological Network

Abstract:

The term gaslighting is widely used today to describe deliberate attempts to undermine a person's sense of reality. Although predominantly studied in romantic relationships, research suggests that gaslighting can occur in any context where a power imbalance exists. In this research, we provide a theoretical framework for understanding gaslighting in the workplace, highlighting its unique position within the workplace mistreatment literature. Next, focusing on the leader-employee dyad, we differentiate between the gaslighting tactics leaders employ (leader gaslighting) and target employees' psychological experience of being gaslit (employee-experienced gaslighting). We also examine whether the consequences of leader gaslighting are conditional on the (in)formal power imbalance between the employee and leader. To test our conceptual model, we first develop separate measures of leader gaslighting tactics and employee-experienced gaslighting and accumulate construct validity evidence across multiple studies (Studies 1a-c, 3). Notably, we find consistent evidence of a bi-factor structure with a "global" destructive leadership factor, and "specific" leader gaslighting, abusive supervision, and social undermining factors. In Study 2, we show that leader gaslighting is positively associated with employee-experienced gaslighting, which in turn adversely impacts self-focused (organizational-based self-esteem and turnover intentions), performance-focused (task performance and workplace deviance), and leader-focused (impression management and affective commitment) outcomes. In Study 4, we show that the direct and indirect negative effects of Acknowledgments: The authors acknowledge the contributions of Kaitlyn Guenther during the early stages of this project, including extensive literature review and initial conceptual work. This research was supported by two grants from the Canadian Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council to the first (435-2020-0529) and second (435-2018-0500) authors.

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3. Social Support and Employee Mental Health: A Meta-Synthesis and Theoretical Framework

Authors: Nathan A. Black, Ekonkar Kaur, Misha Mariam, Christopher M. Barnes
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261433560
Published: 2026-04-07

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Human Resource Management, Occupational Health, Clinical Psychology
- **Theories:** Generic Cognitive Model, Social Support Theory, Integrated Work Support Model

Abstract:

Social support is widely promoted as a key organizational response to employee mental health challenges, yet management research has often overlooked how different sources of support—such as coworkers, line managers, senior leadership, and professional service providers—vary in their effects on employee recovery. This oversight is especially consequential for employees managing common, diagnosable mental health

conditions for whom recovery depends on changes in maladaptive cognitive and behavioral processes that are frequently activated in work contexts. To address this limitation, we conducted an interdisciplinary meta-synthesis of 96 review articles spanning management, clinical psychology, psychiatry, and occupational health. Anchored in Beck and Haigh's Generic Cognitive Model, we develop the Integrated Work Support Model (IWSM), which explains how distinct sources of social support influence activating work situations, maladaptive beliefs, and maladaptive behaviors over time for employees with common mental health conditions. Our synthesis distinguishes the roles of primary, secondary, and tertiary interventions, clarifying when organizational actors can mitigate triggering work conditions, when clinical expertise from professional service providers is required to directly change maladaptive processes, and how social support from actors internal to the organization can enhance—but not substitute for—therapeutic intervention. By integrating clinical theory with management scholarship, this review advances a process-based understanding of social support, specifies role-differentiated responsibilities for organizational actors and professional service providers, and offers actionable guidance for designing social support systems that promote recovery while avoiding unintended harm.

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- **A Prosocial Perspective on Advice Seeking and Networking: How Focusing on What Advice Givers Can Gain Motivates Advice Seekers to Reach Out More** — Academy of Management Journal — 10.5465/amj.2024.0635